Yabo Gwladys Vidogbena

(Updated on November 13, 2026)

Population Studies Center, University of Pennsylvania
133 S 36th Street, Office 632, Philadelphia, PA 19104
yvidogbe@upenn.edu

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Population Studies Center (PSC), University of Pennsylvania — 2025–Present

EDUCATION

University of Houston	Ph.D. in Economics	2020–2025
Dissertation: The Impact of Temperature on Child Cognitive Functioning and Learning		
African Institute for Mathematical Sciences	M.S. in Mathematical Sciences	2017–2018
African School of Economics	Graduate coursework in Economics	2015–2017
École Nationale d'Économie Appliquée et de Management	B.A. in Applied Statistics	2010–2013

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Applied Microeconomics; Economics of Education; Environmental Economics
Secondary: International Trade

PUBLICATIONS

The impacts of temperature on reading and math test scores in West and Central Africa, with Risto Conte Keivabu, Julia Behrman, and Liliana Andriano. *Population and Environment*, **2026, 48(3), 17**.

Structural Change in sub-Saharan Africa: An Open Economy Perspective, with Gaaitzen de Vries, Hagen Kruse, Emmanuel Mensah, and Kei-Mu Yi. *Journal of International Economics*, **2026**.

WORKING PAPERS

Exposure to Heat and Student Cognitive Functioning in Ghana, with Sharon Wolf

Early-Life Heat, Accumulated Effects, Parental Responses and Child Numeracy in Sub-Saharan Africa, with Jere R. Behrman, Emily Hannum, Amrit Thapa and Wendy Chan

WORK IN PROGRESS

Cooling Technology and the Temperature-Learning Relationship: Evidence from West and Central Africa

Secondary School Subsidy for Girls and Educational Attainment: Evidence from Benin

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Houston: Doctoral Researcher, NSF-funded project #2230615	2023–2025
Institute for Empirical Research in Political Economy (Abomey-Calavi, Benin): Research Assistant, IDRC-funded project "Youth Employment and Violence"	2018–2020

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Pennsylvania *(Instructor of Record)*	Econometric Methods and Models (undergraduate)	2025–Present
University of Houston *(Instructor of Record)*	Principles of Macroeconomics	Spring 2024
EGAP Learning Days, CERAP West Africa Hub, Abidjan *(Instructor) — 5-day workshop for researchers and evaluation professionals (FR/EN)*	Causal Inference & Hypothesis Testing	June 2024
EGAP Learning Days, CERAP West Africa Hub, Abidjan *(Instructor) — 5-day workshop for researchers and evaluation professionals (FR/EN)*	Randomization	June 2023

MENTORING & OUTREACH

Peer Mentor, Graduate Applications International Network (GAIN) 2025–2026
Community Teaching Volunteer, Mastercard Foundation Scholars Program, Cameroon 2017–2018
Mentor, girls' education outreach in remote communities, Benin 2017

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

Presidential Graduate Fellowship, University of Houston, 2020–2022
CLASS Dean's Scholarship, University of Houston, 2020–2021
Pre-Doctoral Scholarship, African School of Economics, 2018–2019
Mastercard Foundation Scholarship, African Institute for Mathematical Sciences, 2017–2018
Centre d'Excellence Africain Scholarship, African School of Economics, 2015–2017
Benin Government Scholarship, École Nationale d'Économie Appliquée et de Management, 2010–2013

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Population Association of America 2026 Annual Meeting, St. Louis, MO, US, May 2026
Population Association of America 2025 Annual Meeting, Washington, DC, US, April 2025
CSAE Conference 2025: Economic Development in Africa, Oxford, UK, March 2025
Texas Camp Econometrics 2025, Burnet, TX, US, February 2025
Stata Texas Empirical Microeconomics Conference, Dallas, TX, US, November 2024
Kiel–CEPR African Economic Development Conference, Berlin, Germany, September 2024
2nd Texas Applied Microeconomics Students Workshop, Houston, TX, US, April 2024

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee, Annals of Economics and Statistics
Discussant, CSAE Conference 2025, March 2025
"From Subsidies to Nutrition: Investigating Effects among Cohort Children from the Subsidy Reinvestment and Empowerment Programme in Nigeria" by Uchenna Efobi et al.
Discussant, Citizen-State Interactions in Comparative Perspective, November 2023
"The Impact of Biometric Voter Registration on African Elections" by Paul Friesen & Nicolas van de Walle

SKILLS

Software and programming: Stata, R, Python, MATLAB; LaTeX
Languages: French (fluent), English (fluent)